

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Reading Indian diversity

AXES -> ethnicity, language, religion, region, caste and tribe

RELATION -> layered and overlapping, not parallel lists

TEST -> do the axes cross-cut or reinforce on one household

OUTCOME -> cohesion or compounded marginality

MUST REMEMBER: Indian society is plural, stratified and relational: language, religion, caste, tribe, class, gender, region, rural-urban location and migration overlap, while constitutional citizenship and institutions create unity without erasing difference.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Four-term distinction

DIVERSITY -> objective presence of different identities

PLURALITY -> coexistence with mutual recognition

DISPARITY -> unequal outcomes between groups or regions

MARGINALITY -> exclusion from opportunity, resources or voice

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Linguistic layer

FAMILIES -> Indo-Aryan, Dravidian, Austroasiatic, Tibeto-Burman

RECOGNITION -> Eighth Schedule currently lists 22 languages

CENSUS 2011 -> 19,500 plus raw returns rationalised to 121 languages

LIMIT -> the four-family shorthand is not an exhaustive taxonomy

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Scale of recognised exclusion

CENSUS 2011 -> last completed full count

SCHEDULED TRIBES -> about 8.6 per cent of population

SCHEDULED CASTES -> about 16.6 per cent of population

STATUS -> a stock figure, never a current-year estimate

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Cleavage test

AXES UNCORRELATED -> cross-cutting, diversity stays plural
AXES OVERLAP ON ONE GROUP -> reinforcing, diversity compounds
REINFORCED STACK -> remoteness, low literacy, asset-poverty
VERDICT -> the correlation is conditional, not universal

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Integrative mechanisms

SYNCRETIC IDIOM -> dargahs, Bhakti poets, shared shrines

FESTIVAL CIRCUIT -> Onam, Bihu and Pongal as composite belonging

CIVIC SPACE -> schools, markets, elections, public transport

MIGRATION -> mixed neighbourhoods normalise difference

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Reinforcing case card

SOURCE -> Ministry of Tribal Affairs list dated 9 July 2024

COUNT -> 75 Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups

SPREAD -> 18 States and the UT of Andaman and Nicobar Islands

LIMIT -> administrative criteria, not a ranking of communities

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Counter-evidence pair

DIVERSITY WITHOUT MARGINALITY -> prosperous linguistic-minority traders

ALSO -> several Sikh and Jain business communities

MARGINALITY WITHOUT MARKER -> landless dominant-caste labourer

RULE -> the correlation is neither universal nor symmetric

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Continuity mechanism

ABSORPTION -> add a tradition without extinguishing the earlier one

RECOGNITION -> Eighth Schedule listing of 22 languages

TERRITORY -> States Reorganisation Act, 1956 accommodates language

COST -> hierarchy persisted inside the same continuity

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Recognition and redistribution

RECOGNITION -> respect, visibility and cultural standing

REDISTRIBUTION -> land, credit, schooling and access

MISMATCH -> recognition alone leaves the asset gap intact

DIAGNOSIS -> identify the gap before choosing the instrument

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Diversity is not inequality, pluralism is not assimilation, integration is not homogenisation, and coexistence is not proof of equal power; intersectionality explains combined disadvantages without treating every identity combination as identical.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Evidence ladder

STRONG -> Census 2011 stocks and the dated official PVTG list

MODERATE -> named integrative practices and boundary cases

WEAK -> national aggregates about which sub-group is excluded

UNSUPPORTED -> any caste figure from prospective Census 2027

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Use Census 2011 language/religion baselines, the notified PVTG position and named regional examples with source-date-status labels; neither harmony nor conflict is timeless, and correlation between diversity and marginality is not sufficient causation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Diversity answer spine

OPEN -> state the proposition and the axis structure

BODY -> reinforcing cases, then cross-cutting counter-cases

REFRAME -> exclusion and remoteness are the mechanism

CLOSE -> conditional verdict plus the measurement caveat